

Doris Matilda Czinczoll Gorman

August 23, 1936 – September 26, 2026

Doris Matilda Czinczoll Gorman, 90, of Kansas City, Missouri, died September 26, 2026, surrounded by the love of her family.

Doris was born August 23, 1936, near Chapman, Kansas, to Gustav Valentin Czinczoll and Anna Thiedemann Czinczoll, German immigrants who built a life and raised their family on a Kansas farm. Doris grew up there with her sisters Ruth Ann “Ginger,” Mary “Mim,” and Leanna “Laddie.” She was “Dody” to her sisters, and the four remained extraordinarily close throughout their lives. The girls always made time for a daily phone call.

Farm life made Doris independent early. She gathered eggs, worked in the garden, learned to drive a tractor and, as a teenager, drove the family's big REO truck loaded with grain to the elevator ten miles away. She attended a one-room country school across the road from the family farm and, for much of her childhood, was the only student in her grade. Looking back many years later, Doris reflected, “Life on the farm was good.”

Music became one of the great threads of Doris's life. She learned piano and French horn, sang, and performed in band, orchestra, quartets and ensembles. Her musical ability earned her scholarships, including one to the University of Kansas, where she earned her Bachelor of Music degree. She later became a music teacher, teaching both vocal and instrumental music. She even taught fifth- through eighth-graders how to march in a parade, an accomplishment she remembered with considerable amusement.

While attending KU, Doris met William Bernard “Bill” Gorman, known to many as “Jeep.” Their courtship began in a way few love stories do: Bill and a friend flew an airplane to the Czinczoll farm and landed in her father's pasture, frightening the cows in the process.

Doris wasn't terribly impressed with Bill at first, but he persisted. He began driving to Lawrence every weekend, found a good pizza place, started attending church with her, and eventually, as Doris herself put it, “stole my heart.”

They married at St. Michael's Catholic Church in Chapman on August 23, 1958, Doris's 22nd birthday. Doris and her mother made her wedding gown themselves. Sixty-one years later, her granddaughter Hannah wore that same dress on her own wedding day.

Doris and Bill made their home in Kansas City and became the parents of four sons: Greg, Jeff, Mike and Danny. Family became the center of Doris's life.

She endured losses that would shape the family forever. Bill died in 1977, leaving Doris with four young sons. Less than three years later, their youngest son, Danny, died at age 13.

But Doris did not teach her sons that grief meant life had stopped. There was still family to love and work to be done, and their faith sustained them. Sometimes something was ridiculous enough that you simply had to laugh.

Years later, when Doris wrote about those losses, she remembered the extraordinary kindness shown to her family. She saw that kindness emerge in her sons as they endured those years together. She believed it stayed with them and their families for the rest of her life.

Doris and her friend Jan Strub created a small tax and accounting business that they owned and ran for more than 20 years, serving small businesses and farmers. Turns out, the musician was pretty good at math!

Doris watched Greg, Jeff and Mike grow into men, marry and build families of their own. Then came what she regarded as one of life's greatest rewards: grandchildren.

She was immensely proud of her nine grandchildren: Seth, Will, Paige, Hannah, Tyler, Blake, Shelby, Ryan and Wade. She embraced being a great-grandmother with exactly the same enthusiasm. Grandma's house came with certain privileges. Doris believed grandparents were supposed to do a little spoiling. Pumpkin pie could be breakfast. Cheetos and M&M's were entirely reasonable provisions. And rules that applied at home occasionally became somewhat more flexible at Grandma's.

When Doris was asked what the best thing was about being a mother, grandmother and great-grandmother, her answer was one word: "LOVE."

Doris is survived by her sons Gregory (Nicole) Gorman, age 65, Jeffrey (Tina) Gorman, age 63, and Michael (Renee) Gorman, age 61; her sisters Ruth Ann "Ginger" Gast, age 96, and Leanna "Laddie" Albers, age 86; nine grandchildren; fifteen great-grandchildren; and an extended family and circle of friends who were part of her life.

She was preceded in death by her husband, William "Bill" Gorman (d. 1977); her son Daniel "Danny" Gorman (d. 1980); her parents, Gustav (d. 1970) and Anna Czinczoll (d. 1983); her sister Mary "Mim" Weishaar (age 89, d. 2023); and her longtime business partner and friend Jan Strub (d. 2013).

Doris's Catholic faith was woven through her life rather than reserved for Sundays. She was a member of St. Andrew the Apostle Catholic Church. Everyone there, including the priests, called her "GG." Her great-grandchildren had given her the name for Great Grandma, and she truly enjoyed it. She always signed her cards "GG." Sundays were always church and Chiefs, in that order. Doris prayed the rosary every night for her sons, daughters-in-law, grandchildren and great-grandchildren.

Doris was a longtime active member of the Alpha Gamma Master Chapter of Beta Sigma Phi. The women in her chapter became her second family, and they cared for one another like sisters.

Doris was an avid Royals and Chiefs fan and never missed a game on TV. She and Bill were members of the Wolfpack in its early days and held season tickets for both teams for many years before his death. Not long ago, she attended a Royals game in person, where she was showered with gifts and enjoyed a memorable day at the ballpark.

When Doris looked back on her life, she wrote about faith, kindness, music, family, friendship, laughter and gratitude. She loved her sisters and her boys, spoiled her grandchildren and adored her great-grandchildren. She remained proud of the Kansas farm where her story began.

And she never entirely lost the mischievous farm girl who once drove around the countryside throwing firecrackers from a truck, only to discover afterward that one of the neighbors had a propane tank beside the driveway. She survived that particular adventure, although her father reportedly had a few things to say about it.

Doris ended one of her stories about her family with words that now seem a fitting way to end the story of her own life: "My family is the greatest! GOD BLESS ALL OF YOU."

The viewing will be held at Newcomer's White Chapel Funeral Home, 6600 NE Antioch Road, Gladstone, Missouri. The funeral will be held at St. Andrew the Apostle Catholic Church, 6415 NE Antioch Road, Gladstone, Missouri. Dates and times will be announced.

Interment will be at Resurrection Cemetery, 5001 NE Cookingham Road, Kansas City, Missouri, beside her husband, Bill, and her son, Danny.

In lieu of flowers, the family asks for donations to St. Andrew the Apostle Catholic Church.